

THE GOOD DOLL

A Test-and-Learn Offline Retail Strategy

Not “where should we open 250 stores” - but “which retail formats, for which audience, actually make Nilah profitable.” Built for a ₹1 Cr budget, 24–36 months.

100,000+

Dolls sold

80+

Retail doors today

2

Distinct audiences, 1 brand

₹1 Cr

Test-and-scale budget

Two audiences, one brand | and a nostalgia angle India already has

ICP A · THE INTENTIONAL PARENT (25–40)

- Buys FOR a child (2-8 yrs) - birthday, festival gifting, “screen-time-free toy” search
- Values craft & safety over mass plastic; will pay a premium if trust is established at shelf
- Channel pull: FirstCry, Hamleys, bookstore chains, kids' boutiques

ICP B · THE NOSTALGIC ADULT (25-45) - NEW

25-35 · SELF-GIFTER

Buys Nilah for herself - desk companion, shelf décor, friend-gift. Same psychology driving Sonny Angel, Jellycat & Labubu: adults are now the single largest toy-buying cohort globally.

35-45 · NOSTALGIC COLLECTOR

Buys Nilah as a collectible/display piece - echoes the Golu/Bomma Kolu tradition of adding a new doll to the family's festival display every year.

Channel pull: Chumbak / Nappa Dori / Kulture Shop, Golu & festival markets, Ooty-Coonoor tourism retail, Instagram drops, design fairs

THE INSIGHT

The “kidult” collector trend the toy industry treats as a new phenomenon is something Tamil Nadu, Karnataka and Andhra households have practiced for generations through Navratri Golu displays. Nilah doesn't need to import a foreign collector culture, it can plug into one that already exists in its own home market.

Cultural storytelling and seasonal limited-edition drops for regional markets

THE STORYTELLING UNIVERSE

- Core Nilah Character: The permanent brand hero, representing the Nilgiris mountains, acting as the narrative anchor.
- Introducing "Nilah's Cousins": Character extensions dressed in regional handloom textiles, introduced through a serialized picture-book/content universe.
- Cultivating Scarcity: Limited festival drops (500-1,000 units per run) to drive seasonal gift-giving and collector urgency.

FESTIVAL SKUS & MARKETS

• Tara (Maharashtra) • Gudi Padwa

Dressed in upcycled Paithani silk handloom textiles. Targeted at Mumbai and Pune boutiques and festival pop-ups.

• Kasavu-Nilah (Kerala) • Onam

Dressed in cream-and-gold Kasavu handloom cotton. Targeted at Kochi tourism retail, local airport shops, and Onam gifting.

• Ilkal-Nilah (Karnataka) • Rajyotsava / Dussehra

Dressed in traditional Ilkal handloom border textiles. Targeted at Bengaluru airport kiosks and Dasara Golu festival markets.

Every channel is a testable hypothesis, not a pre-decided winner

Scored on Customer Fit × Reach/Scale × Brand Control. FirstCry and Hamleys are not excluded for being “mass” — the real question is whether Nilah can sell through without losing its story.

Channel	Fit	Reach/Scale	Brand Ctrl.	Primary audience	Role
FirstCry	Very High	Very High (1,200+ stores)	Medium	Kids-parent	Scale test
Hamleys	High	High	Medium	Kids-parent + gifting	Scale test
Bookstore chains (Crossword, Sapna)	Med-High	High	Medium	Kids-parent	Scale test
Kids' boutiques (independent)	High	Low	High	Kids-parent	Brand-building test
Design-gifting stores (Chumbak, Nappa Dori, Kulture Shop)	High	Medium	High	Adult self-gifter 25-35	New-audience test
Golu / festival doll markets (seasonal)	Very High	Med (seasonal)	High	Nostalgic collector 35-45	High-conviction test
Museum, craft & heritage-tourism retail	High	Low	High	Nostalgic collector + tourists	Selective, story-native
Airport retail	Medium	Medium	Medium	Gifting (NRI/relatives)	Gifting test
Corporate / work-desk gifting programs	Med-High	Medium	Medium	Adult self-gifter 25-45	New B2B test
Pop-ups, Instagram drops & design fairs	High	Low	Very High	Both adult segments	Market-sensing test

TWO MORE, NEXT

Home-turf channels unique to the Nilgiris — tourism circuit + premium boarding schools — get their own deep-dive on the next two slides.

Prioritization framework based on purchasing power, retail footprint, cultural Golu fit, and logistics

Scored from 1-10: Income (35%), Partner Stores (25%), Golu Fit (25%), and Logistics (15%). Sourced from PRICE-Tata Sons report.

Channel	Fit	Reach/Scale	Brand Ctrl.	Primary audience	Role
City	HH Income (35%)	Partners (25%)	Golu Fit (25%)	Logistics (15%)	Weighted Score
Bengaluru	10 (₹28L/yr)	10 (30+ doors)	8	9	9.35 (Year 1)
Chennai	8 (₹16L/yr)	8 (18 doors)	10	8	8.50 (Year 1)
Mumbai	10 (₹24L/yr)	10 (35 doors)	6	6	8.40 (Year 1)
Coimbatore	7 (₹14L/yr)	6 (6 doors)	9	10	7.70 (Year 1)
Delhi NCR	9 (₹22L/yr)	10 (40 doors)	5	5	7.65 (Year 2)
Hyderabad	8 (₹20L/yr)	8 (15 doors)	6	7	7.35 (Year 2)
Pune	8 (₹18L/yr)	7 (12 doors)	6	6	6.95 (Year 2)
Kochi	6 (₹12L/yr)	5 (4 doors)	5	8	5.80 (Year 2)

TWO MORE, NEXT

Home-turf channels unique to the Nilgiris - tourism circuit + premium boarding schools - get their own deep-dive on the next two slides.

Optimise for productive doors, not store count



RETAIL PARTNER LADDER

TIER 1 • SCALE CANDIDATES

FirstCry · Hamleys · Crossword

Highest reach; pilot and let sell-through decide, don't crown a winner upfront

TIER 2 • AUDIENCE-FIT CANDIDATES

Chumbak · Nappa Dori · Kulture Shop · independent boutiques

Opens the 25-45 self-gifter audience the kids-only channels can't reach

TIER 3 • EXPERIENTIAL / SELECTIVE

Golu markets · museums · Ooty tourism circuit · Ooty schools · airports (via Relay / Shoppers Stop consignment) · B2B preschools (welcome kits) · pop-ups

Low scale, high story-fit - protects premium positioning, tests new formats cheaply

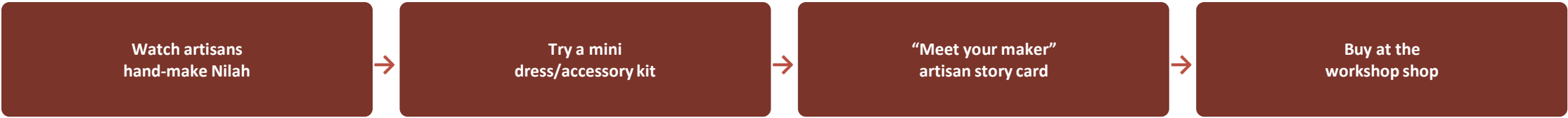
Ooty's tourism industry already sells the exact experience Nilah needs

Ooty runs on a proven retail format TGD hasn't used yet: the factory-tour-to-shop model. The Tea Factory & Chocolate Factory circuits (live process demo → free tasting → DIY kit → souvenir shop) are among the most-visited stops in Ooty. Nilah's own making process is at least as compelling a story.

THE PROVEN MODEL (already working for tea & chocolate in Ooty)



NILAH'S VERSION: THE MAKER TRAIL



HOW TO PLUG INTO EXISTING TOURIST FLOW (no need to build footfall from scratch)

Tour operator bundling:

Get listed as a stop on the standard Ooty sightseeing circuit alongside Tea Factory, Chocolate Factory, Botanical Garden, Doddabetta - same tour buses, zero extra ad spend

Cross-referral with tea/chocolate factories:

Adjacent, non-competing craft experiences already send each other's visitors back and forth - easiest possible partnership to open

Ooty Chocolate Festival (Dec):

TGD could run a Nilah booth/pop-up at this existing high-footfall seasonal event instead of creating a new one

Hotel & resort concierge tie-ups:

Kids'-activity corners and gift-shop placement in family-oriented Ooty resorts, converting a stay into a purchase

A tiny number of doors, an extremely premium and captive audience

Ooty hosts several of India's most prestigious residential schools - drawing high-net-worth families from across India and abroad, multiple times a year, for events where hundreds of parents are physically present and already primed to spend on their child.

School	Why it matters	Indicative fee
The Lawrence School, Lovedale	700-acre campus, 861 students, est. 1858, families from across India	₹6L/yr
Good Shepherd International	IB/IGCSE, most expensive school in Ooty	₹10–19L/yr
Hebron School	International, Cambridge IGCSE/A-Level, multicultural student body	₹4L/yr
Breeks Memorial, Woodside, St Hilda's, JSS	Established day-cum-boarding schools, strong local + regional draw	₹2–6L/yr

WHY THIS AUDIENCE

Fee ranges of ₹4-19L/year mean these are households with genuinely high discretionary spend - exactly the profile that buys Premium-tier (₹2,500+) Nilah bundles without hesitation.

HIGH-VALUE TOUCHPOINTS ON THE SCHOOL CALENDAR

New-boarder welcome kits:
A Nilah as a genuine comfort companion for young boarders away from home for the first time - the exact emotional job the brand is built for

Founder's Day / Sports Day / Prize Day:
Hundreds of affluent parents on campus at once; a small retail table or gifting tie-in reaches them with zero media spend

School store / canteen shelf:
A tiny, permanent, high-conviction door - low volume, near-zero CAC, strong brand-safety halo

Alumni & parent gifting programmes:
Schools already run branded-merchandise gifting; a co-branded “made in the Nilgiris” limited edition rides on existing alumni-association demand

Small door count, but this is the highest-conviction, lowest-cost test in the entire portfolio - worth piloting in Year 1 regardless of scale.

Targeting early transition touchpoints: Kidzee, EuroKids, Little Millennium, Apple Kids

Dolls act as comfort companions to resolve first-day separation anxiety. Bulk kits are sold at ₹450-₹500 (50-60% off MRP) using simplified dress-sets in upcycled cotton bags, maintaining a 50% gross margin with 0% returns.

School	Why it matters	Indicative fee
Preschool Chain	Direct Reach (India-wide)	Target Integration
Kidzee	2,000+ Centers (Largest network)	Custom "My First Companion" welcome kit
EuroKids	1,200+ Centers	Themed story-box integration (curriculum)
Little Millennium / Apple Kids	750+ Centers	Co-branded graduation day gift hampers

WHY THIS CHANNEL

Prepaid bulk orders improve cash flow (50% advance, 50% on delivery), and parents scanning the QR codes on the Welcome Kit drive organic D2C traffic with zero CAC.

ORGANIC D2C LOOP

New-boarder welcome kits:

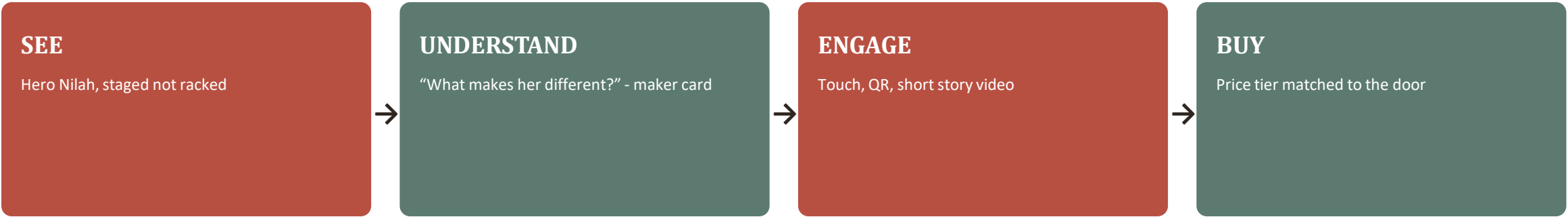
A Nilah as a genuine comfort companion for young boarders away from home for the first time - the exact emotional job the brand is built for

Three price tiers, four seconds to earn attention

HERO	₹1,000-₹1,500	CORE	₹1,500-₹2,500	PREMIUM	₹2,500+
Single doll, both ICPs Acquisition & discovery — the low-commitment entry point at every channel		Family sets / 2-doll bundles Repeat purchase & gifting — feeds the Golu “add one every year” collecting logic		Limited/festival editions, curated bundles Occasion-driven — Navratri specials, anniversary drops, corporate & school gifting sets	

Test which channel × price tier combination drives the best sell-through - don't assume every door needs the full range.

WIN THE SHELF IN 3 SECONDS

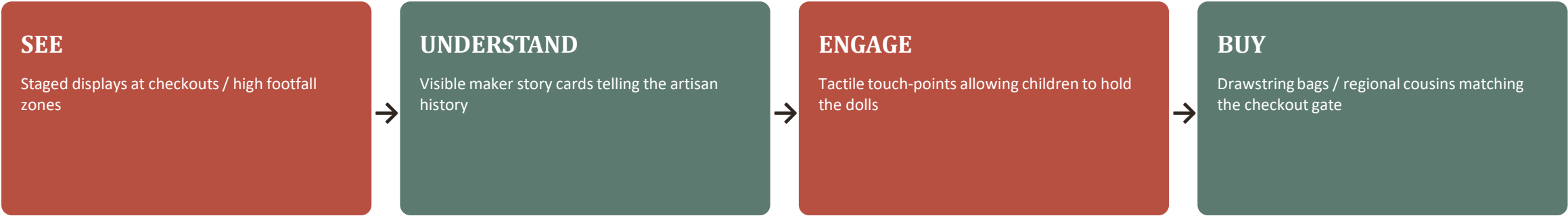


Artisanal countertop CDUs, floor spinners, and interactive preschool cradles

COUNTERTOP CDU FSC Pine Wood Stand (\$60x40x45 cm) Natural finish wooden unit with forest-diorama backing. Stages 3 Hero dolls. Includes "Meet the Maker" cardholder and dynamic QR placard.	AIRPORT FLOOR SPINNER Rubberwood Pegboard (\$45 cm dia x 150 cm) Compact floor spinner. Displays dolls hanging in upcycled drawstring bags. Features central acrylic shadow-box for Nilah's regional cousins.	PRESCHOOL CRADLE Low-Height Wicker Cradle (\$50 cm) Low basket filled with sitting dolls placed in preschool corridors. Invites tactile play with open sign: "Can you give Nilah a home?"
---	--	--

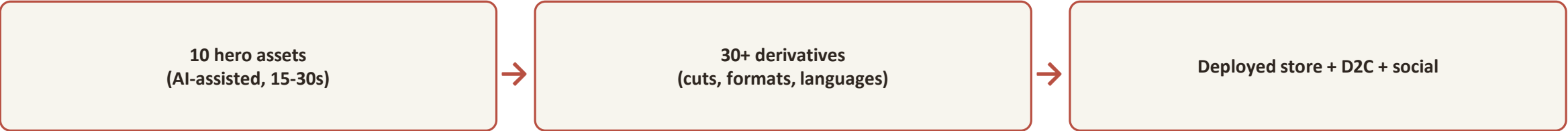
Displays use natural woods, upcycled handloom textiles, and earthy tones to reflect the brand's Nilgiris origin.

DISPLAY PLACEMENT GUIDELINES



Replacing a static QR with a reusable Nilah content system

A small library of AI-assisted hero videos, cut into dozens of derivatives, deployed everywhere - turning merchandising into a scalable content asset rather than a one-off shoot.



CONTENT ANGLES BY AUDIENCE

Kids-parent ICP

“Hi, I’m Nilah...” · “Meet my family” · “How my dress is made” · “3 ways to play with Nilah”

Nostalgic-adult ICP

Collector-edition drop reveals · the Nilgiris origin story · “add her to your Golu this year”
seasonal content · desk-companion styling

12-MONTH PILOT BUDGET | ₹1.95L - ₹3.25L (within the ₹1 Cr envelope)

AI video tools / subscriptions	₹25K-₹50K
Character & story development	₹30K-₹50K
8-12 hero videos	₹75K-₹1.25L
20-30 short-form derivatives	₹40K-₹60K
Editing / localisation / formats	₹25K-₹40K

Don't spend it on 3 beautiful videos, spend it on a reusable system. Indicative AI 15-30s clips run ₹8K-₹40K each in-market; tools like HeyGen start near \$29-49/mo.

Comparative channel economics (MRP ₹1,250) and working capital cycle days

Consignment retail yields higher unit contribution (₹328) than D2C (₹296) due to high online CAC. Wholesale has lower margins (₹272) but reduces the cash cycle from 120 days to 15 days.

Units / month	Monthly contribution	Est. store-attributable cost	Net	Verdict
Line Item	1. Consignment (Hamleys)	2. Wholesale (Distributor)	3. Online D2C (Website)	
MRP	₹1,250	₹1,250	₹1,250	
Less: GST (12%)	₹134	₹134	₹134	
Retailer Margin	₹500 (40%)	₹375 (30%)	-	
Distributor Margin	-	₹125 (10%)	-	
Logistics & Packaging	₹50 (Bulk Freight)	₹25 (Bulk Cargo)	₹120 (Courier + PG)	
Returns / CAC / RTO	₹38 (3% damage)	₹0 (No returns)	₹450 (CAC + RTO)	
Artisan COGS	₹250	₹250	₹250	
Net Unit Contribution	₹328 (26.2%)	₹272 (21.8%)	₹296 (23.7%)	
Working Capital Cycle	120 Days (Consignment)	15 Days (Wholesale)	45 Days (D2C)	

CASH FLOW STRATEGY

Consignment is a high-margin brand builder but cash-intensive (120-day cycle). B2B Preschool and Wholesale channels are highly cash-efficient (15-day cycle), releasing capital to fund display rollouts.

The goal isn't 250 stores | it's a predictable retail formula

0–12 MO · TEST	₹40L	12–24 MO · PROVE	₹35L	24–36 MO · SCALE	₹25L
• 3-4 cities: Bengaluru, Chennai, Mumbai, Coimbatore • Scale track: First Cry + Hamleys pilot doors (20-30) • Audience track: 3-5 Chumbak/Nappa Dori doors + 1 Golu-season market • Home-turf: pilot Ooty maker-trail experience + 2-3 school touchpoints • AI content engine live; KPI: sell-through, contribution/store		• Expand only channel x city combinations clearing the sell-through threshold • Convert top-decile doors to wholesale • Add Wave 2 cities: Delhi NCR, Hyderabad, Pune, Kochi • Scale school partnerships if Year-1 pilot converts to repeat D2C • KPI: retail = 15-20% of revenue, doors profitable at store level		• National rollout of proven formula only - not a fixed door-count target • Formal distributor for Tier-2/3; evaluate 1 flagship store • Ooty maker-trail becomes a permanent, ticketed brand experience • KPI: national doll-of-choice in curated + collector retail	

Phased allocation of the ₹1 Crore budget over 24-36 months

0–12 MO • TEST	₹40L Budget	12–24 MO • PROVE	₹35L Budget	24–36 MO • SCALE	₹25L Budget
• Artisan Wages & Materials: ₹10.0L (4,000 units) • POSM Displays & CDUs: ₹6.0L (40 CDUs, 20 stands) • Airport Consignment Slot Fees: ₹5.0L • Preschool welcome-kit samples: ₹4.0L • AI Content Setup: ₹3.0L • Freight & Logistics: ₹2.0L • Working Capital float: ₹10.0L		• Cousin SKU & Production Scale: ₹12.0L • POSM for 50 new doors: ₹5.0L • Preschool Bulk welcome-kits: ₹6.0L • Logistics & 3PL Warehousing: ₹3.0L • Working Capital reserves: ₹7.0L • AI content regional translation: ₹2.0L		• Distributor Rollout support: ₹5.0L • Ooty Maker-Trail Center: ₹10.0L • National PR & Launches: ₹6.0L • Freight & Ops Contingency: ₹4.0L	

Mitigating certification, tax, and supply risks for 100% workability

REGULATORY COMPLIANCE

- Artisan Exemption under Toys QCO 2020: Register SHG artisan clusters with DC (Handicrafts), Ministry of Textiles, to legally bypass compulsory BIS licensing/ISI marking.
- Multi-State GST Setup: Obtain state-specific GSTINs in Maharashtra, Karnataka, and Delhi via virtual offices to legally enable interstate consignment sales.

OPERATIONAL RISK MITIGATION

- **Supply Chain Security (Dual-Cluster):** Establish a "Train-the-Trainer" hub in Coimbatore plains to bypass Nilgiris monsoon landslips and scale capacity.
- **Display Manufacturing Optimization:** Outsource wooden CDU production to Saharanpur/Jodhpur, reducing display unit costs from ₹8,000 to ₹4,500.